

MASTERY OF MATERIALITIES

*Resources and Technology in Post-Imjin
War East Asia (1598-1650)*

4-5 September, 2023

UNIVERSITAT AUTÒNOMA DE BARCELONA

Torre Vila Puig UAB

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CONFERENCE PROGRAM

4 Sept

8:30-8:45	<i>Opening Remarks</i>
8:45-10:15	I. Knowledge Capture Finding and Exploiting Expertise in Prisoners and Displaced Persons
10:15-10:30	<i>Coffee Break</i>
10:30-12:00	II. Reclaiming Resources Administering Raw Materials in the Wake of War
12:00-13:00	III-1. The Cutting Edge Weapons Technology in Postwar East Asia
13:00-14:30	<i>Lunch</i>
14:30-15:30	III-2. The Cutting Edge Weapons Technology in Postwar East Asia
15:30-15:45	<i>Coffee Break</i>
15:45-16:45	Roundtable I. Material Interests — Writing Histories of Resources
15:45-17:15	Day 1 Wrap-up & Reflections
17:15-20:30	<i>Free Time</i>
20:30-22:30	<i>Conference Dinner (Sol Soler, Plaça del Sol, Vila de Gracia)</i>

5 Sept

8:30-10:00	IV. Observe & Report Information Flows and Information Obstacles
10:00-10:15	<i>Coffee Break</i>
10:15-11:45	V. Mastering the Peace Civilian Technologies after Conflict
11:45-12:00	<i>Coffee Break</i>
12:00-13:00	Roundtable II. Assessing the Iberian Impact in East Asia
13:00-13:30	Closing Remarks
13:30-15:30	<i>Lunch</i>

PANELS

Panel Session 1 — Knowledge Capture

Finding and Exploiting Expertise in Prisoners and Displaced Persons

- ✦ *Rebekah Clements* (ICREA; UAB) - Korean Potters and the Satsuma Domain
- ✦ *Yang Liu* (University of Oxford) - From Natives to Captives: The Transformed Lives of the Imjin War Prisoners.
- ✦ *Yan Hon Michael Chung* (Emory University) - After Acquiring the Cannons: The Pre-conquest Qing Gunnery Training Program and its Political Impact (1631-1643)
- ✦ Discussant: *Wim Boot* (Leiden University)

Panel Session 2 — Reclaiming Resources

Administering Raw Materials in the Wake of War

- ✦ *Joshua Batts* (UAB) - A Wealth of Interests: Managing Minerals in Early Tokugawa Japan
- ✦ *John Lee* (Durham University) - Reclaiming the Maritime Periphery: Resources, Ecologies, and the Integration of the Coastal Archipelago in Post-Imjin Korea
- ✦ *Kizaki Braddick* (University of Oxford) - Mottainai: Castle Recycling During the Early Edo Period
- ✦ Discussant: *Jose Miguel Escribano Paez* (Universidad Pablo de Olavide)

Panel Session 3 — The Cutting Edge

Weapons Technology in Postwar East Asia

- ✦ *Lee Jeong-il* (Northeast Asia History Foundation) - Lee Jeong-il - Tactical Changes and Regional Security in the East Asian War: Chosŏn Perspectives
- ✦ *Hyeok Hweon Kang* (Washington University of St. Louis) - Military Technology as Literacy: The Codification of Technical Knowledge in Korean Military Workshops, 1592–1635
- ✦ *Barend Noordam* (UAB) - Normalizing the Navy: Ming Naval Expansion after the Imjin War
- ✦ *Eder A.J. Gallegos Ruiz* (Universidad Pablo de Olavide) - From the Coasts of China to the Atlantic: The Artillery Foundry of Manila, a Global Technical Circulation (1590-1650)
- ✦ Discussant: *Kenneth Swope* (University of Southern Mississippi)

Panel Session 4 — Observe & Report

Information Flows and Information Obstacles

- ✦ Alexander Jost (University of Salzburg) - European Ideas on Orogenesis, Mining and Metallurgy in 17th century China
- ✦ Cheng Wei-Chung (Academia Sinica) - Sailing across the South China Sea: An Ignored Iberian Maritime Route in Dutch Records
- ✦ Louis Hou (Columbia University) - Embracing Practicality: A Study on the Sources of Seonjo's Post-imjin-War Military Reform
- ✦ Discussant: Omar Svriz Wucherer (University of Seville)

Panel Session 5 — Mastering the Peace

Civilian Technologies After Conflict

- ✦ Hasegawa Masato (National Taiwan University) - The Ming Withdrawal from Korea and the Beginning of the Imjin War's Aftermath
- ✦ Gowoon Seong (Fudan University) - A Study on Ming Ceramics Inscribed with "Great Ming" as a Memorial Function after the Imjin War
- ✦ Baihui Duan (University of Oxford) - Medical Legacies of the Imjin War: Environment, Diseases, War, and Medicine
- ✦ Discussant: Yongchao Cheng (Tohoku University)

Roundtable 1

Material Interests – Writing Histories of Resources

- ✦ Moderators: Barend Noordam, Jing Hu (KU Leuven; UAB), Yongchao Cheng

Roundtable 2

Assessing the Iberian Impact in East Asia

- ✦ Moderators: Joshua Batts, David Spafford (University of Pennsylvania), Jaime González Bolado (UAB)



ABSTRACTS

Joshua Batts - A Wealth of Interests: Managing Minerals in Early Tokugawa Japan

Within weeks of his victory at Sekigahara, Tokugawa Ieyasu claimed Japan's mineral wealth for himself. Overviews of the Tokugawa transition dutifully note the takeover, listing alongside control of major cities and consolidation of foreign relations as examples of Tokugawa rulership establishing its prerogative. But where city life and foreign relations are linchpins of Anglophone scholarship, little work has been done on mineral management, especially when considered as distinct from silver circulation. Furthermore, Tokugawa consolidation followed a massive outlay of resources in the form of Hideyoshi's invasions of the Korean peninsula. This paper draws on sources from Iwami and Sado mine complexes to consider Tokugawa wealth and mineral management in the context of the shogunate's position as a postwar political entity. How did the war impact governance of the archipelago's precious resources and administrators' exploration of relevant mining technologies? How was this relatively smooth transition to Tokugawa oversight executed, and what does it teach us about the shogunate's initial approaches to human and resource management? In short, what happened when priorities shifted from advancing expansion abroad to maximising extraction within a postwar realm? I explore these links as an initial effort to bridge the historical and historiographical gaps between foreign relations and domestic governance, and thereby present a more integrated view of early Tokugawa rule.

Kizaki Braddick - Mottainai: Castle Recycling During the Early Edo Period

In recent years, the frugal lifestyle epitomised by Edo era Japan has been embraced by the global environmental movement as a paradigm of self-sufficiency and sustainability. With little if any historical context, Tokugawa Japan is widely admired as a culture which can teach invaluable lessons to our wasteful 'throwaway' modern societies as we confront resource scarcity, loss of biodiversity, and climate breakdown. In 'resource poor' Japan, the repurposing of virtually all objects, whether made from paper, cotton, wood, clay, stone, or metal, is a tradition of long standing, and this practice apparently reached its zenith during the Tokugawa era.

It is generally assumed that the mottainai mantra which dominated Tokugawa society rested on a combination of a limited resource base, pragmatism, and religion; in particular, a Buddhist respect for the essence of all things. Yet, some aspects of this celebrated cultural heritage have thus far been overlooked and warrant further investigation. This paper seeks to approach the reuse/repurpose/recycle debate from

a new perspective by examining the reutilization of castle components during the early Edo period.

The recycling of large buildings was not a phenomenon new this era, but it became normalised. The first fifteen years of the 17th century witnessed a boom in castle building throughout Japan, facilitated by the rapid dissemination of improved construction techniques, for which Hizen Nagoya Castle acted as a catalyst. Nevertheless, during this period, several major castles were dismantled, with sections being repurposed not only for use in other castles, but also in temples and gardens. For example, it is often claimed that one of the six massive gates of Hizen Nagoya, was transported over 1,100km northwards to Sendai Castle, while most of the remaining materials were used to build the nearby Karatsu Castle. Rather more macabre was the reuse of bloodstained floorboards from Fushimi Castle as ceiling beams and panels in a number of Kyoto temples; its gates and towers being recycled for use elsewhere. It appears that Hikone Castle not only sourced its stones from nearby castles, but also from temples, shrines, Buddhas, and pagodas. Objects from destroyed castles, such as swords and tea caddies from Osaka Castle were re-forged and re-formed.

This topic prompts a number of questions: 1). Why do historical records and archaeological findings often contradict each other? 2). Why were parts of some castles rescued while others were simply destroyed, or allowed to fall into decay? and 3). Was reusability deliberately built into castle design? Reusing castle elements differed fundamentally from recycling paper or old clothes because it reflected a wider range of motives, including redistributing strategic power, erasing political legacies, raising social status, and/or memorializing military sacrifice. In short, there appears to have been three overarching factors propelling castle recycling during the early Edo period, namely: economic, military-strategic, and political-cultural.

Cheng Wei-chung - Sailing across the South China Sea: An Ignored Iberian Maritime Route in Dutch Records

Some records written by Antonio de Morga and Jacques de Coutre prove that at least since the 1580s there were some human flows of Castilians between Siam and Manila via multiple ways. Two expeditions were dispatched separately from Manila to Cambodia in 1596 and 1599. It seems the fleet was taking the route directly across the South China Sea, even though the actual sailing trail had never been recorded. The Dutch presence had been getting stronger since their first successful voyage to Java in 1598. During 1616 and 1617 the VOC dispatched several expeditions to blockade Manila. In June 1619, after “a treaty of Defense” was signed in Europe by these two Protestant countries: the Dutch and English. Their fleets in Asia then became able to organize further struggle against the Iberians. When the Anglo-Dutch Defense fleet was

blockading Manila in April 1622, the Dutch Batavian authorities decided to launch another expedition to seize Macau from Portuguese hands. When the Dutch fleet arrived at the waters offshore between the Bay of Phanrang and Camranh, the commander Reijerszoon dispatched a yacht, the St. Nicolaes, to Manila for collecting more Dutch vessels. It must have sailed across the south China Sea to reach the Manila waters. In one of the following expeditions to blockade Manila, a branch squad of Dutch flotilla sailed across South China Sea from Pulau Tioman to Manila in 1646, even with a “ sailing direction”. This article examines these several trails of Dutch vessels actually went through South China sea and thus disclose one important sailing route connecting Cochinchina and Manila assumably developed by Iberians and sailed by multiple ethnic traders since the early 17th century.

Yan Hon Michael Chung – After Acquiring the Cannons: The Pre-conquest Qing Gunnery Training Program and its Political Impact (1631-1643)

This study examines the Qing's first gunnery program, which was proposed by the Han subjects of the Manchu khanate in the early 1630s. This program turned the defected or captured Han gunners from Ming China into gunnery trainers and used them to train artillery units. This effectively institutionalized the gunnery technical transfer within the artillery corps. The gunnery training program yielded remarkable results. According to Baqi Tongzhi, the number of officer-grade gunners increased more than sixfold within ten years; and, many of the gunners had multiple artillery-sieging experiences. This prepared the Qing with a strong artillery corps ready to fight a multi-front war again the Ming. After the Qing conquered Beijing in 1644, the Qing was able to deploy its artillery units at multiple points simultaneously combating various parties.

But the gunnery training program was not a mere military program, it was also a political campaign for the Han subjects. The program extracted the Han gunnery specialists, many of them originally serving as bondservants in the Manchu households, into the Hanjun, an institution headed by the Han elites. As the Hanjun (which means Chinese/Han army in Chinese) expanded and institutionalized, the political influence of the Han elites also augmented. Furthermore, as the gunnery training program was exclusively for the Han population, this allowed the Han to monopolize the technology, a process which I term “ethnicizing artillery technology.” As Hanjun expanded in size and its artillery corps rose in strategic value, the Han was in a better position to negotiate with the Manchu court for social and political influence. Eventually, in 1642, the Hanjun Eight Banners was created. The group of Han military personnel was finally admitted into the privileged class of the Manchu state, and; this helped declare the Manchu-Mongol-Han ethnic setting of the emerging Qing empire.

To conclude briefly, this proposed study offers a curious case to demonstrate how European artillery technology interacted with the pre-conquest Qing state and influenced its ethnic-political setting. Furthermore, this study also experiments with GIS and statistical methods to better evaluate the spread of the gunnery techniques and the increase of number of Han gunners.

Rebekah Clements – Mastering Human Materialities: The Use and Display of Captured Korean Potters in Satsuma Domain

In 1593, during the second year of the Imjin War, Toyotomi Hideyoshi ordered his generals to present him with any "craftspeople, embroiderers, or skilled women" found among their captives. "Craftspeople" (*saiku shisha* 細工仕者) is usually understood as referring to the ceramic artisans for whom Chosŏn Korea was famous. Although there are records of a captured seamstress being sent to Hideyoshi, there is no evidence that he received any potters. However, several of his generals brought highly skilled ceramic artisans to their domains in southern Japan, where they founded or revitalized local pottery traditions, some of which are among the most famous in Japan today, including Arita ware, Karatsu ware, and Hagi ware. Of particular note, due to their survival into the modern period, is the community of potters still active in Higashiichiki-chō Miyama in Kagoshima prefecture, a village formerly known as Naeshirogawa, which was located in the premodern Japanese domain of Satsuma. After the Imjin War, pottery produced by captured Koreans in Naeshirogawa for domestic use helped the Satsuma economy, and the official domain kiln, which was also founded and staffed by captured Koreans, produced "White Satsuma" prestige wares which were used on important occasions and given as gifts by the Shimazu to other high-ranking warriors.

This presentation will use the conceptual similarities between Satsuma's Korean potters and the ceramic objects they produced, drawing upon the breakdown of the absolute ontological distinction between humans and things, which has resulted from the material turn in cultural studies. During the sixteenth to seventeenth centuries, elite Japanese warriors demonstrated power through what Morgan Pitelka has called the "spectacular accumulation" and display of material objects including ceramics. These objects, particularly named tea ceremony vessels, may be understood as having a kind of agency; not that they had free will or intentionality, but that they had properties and cultural meanings that powerfully shaped the activities of their human creators and collectors. Conversely, the ceramic artisans themselves, such as the Naeshirogawa potters, were "accumulated" and displayed like objects by warrior elites, due to the importance of the cultural capital they possessed, including knowledge of ceramic production techniques.

There were regular displays of this embodied cultural capital during visits to Naeshirogawa by the Satsuma lords, and unlike other communities of captured Koreans in Japan, the Naeshirogawa residents were not assimilated into the local population. This was due to the fact that Satsuma's system of social organization included a special status category for them, and prohibited the Koreans to marry outside of their village, preserving Korean language, dress, music, dance, and ceramic technology in Naeshirogawa throughout the Tokugawa period. In the post Imjin Period, the lords of Satsuma domain thus mastered the materiality of the ceramic pieces produced by the Naeshirogawa potters as well as the ceramic artisans themselves.

Duan Baihui - Medical Legacies of the Imjin War: Environment, Diseases, War, and Medicine

Emerging scholarship on global history of war, focusing on the health of soldiers, has examined the interconnectedness among war, diseases, medicine, and states. Nevertheless, medical care during and after the Imjin War has never drawn any attention among scholarship except for a few studies limited to some diseases and logistic problems. Such ignorance of premodern military medicine was partially because of seeing concerns for the health of soldiers as belonging to public health as a quintessentially modern phenomenon, enabled by the emergence of advanced biomedicine. Instead, this study is not an analysis of the effectiveness of premodern military medical practice, but notes how the wartime Sino-Chosŏn medical alliance was formed from the perspective of contemporaries. Moreover, the nature of the post-Imjin medical legacies in East Asia will be scrutinized, adding to the historiography of military medicine in general. This study demonstrates that the knowledge of the cold climate in the north and humid coastal climate in the south of the Korean peninsula and incidence of diseases among soldiers and horses played a significant role in the formation of war preparations, wartime strategies and medicine supply policies among the combatant authorities. Physical conditions, in turn, stimulated wartime military medicine, especially the Sino-Chosŏn medical collaboration against diseases. Moreover, in the post-Imjin period, Chosŏn witnessed an institutionalization of some temporary medical officials in military armies and a circulation of military medical manuals within East Asia, thus achieving the militarization of medicine.

Eder A.J. Gallegos Ruiz - From the Coasts of China to the Atlantic: The Artillery Foundry of Manila, a Global Technical Circulation (1590-1650)

This research focuses on the technical Asian and Iberian agents and technology necessary for the casting of bronze artillery in the city of Manila for the Galleon sent

to Acapulco and coastal fortresses in the rest of Philippine Islands (1590-1650). From the first influence of Japanese and native Muslims inhabitants, knowledgeable about "lantakas" and the Portuguese artillery-making technique, to the arrival of Hispanic foundries who employed native Philippines and Chinese artisans (sangleyes) since 1598 to make new bronze cannons with Asian metals (thanks to the linguistic mediation of Dominicans and Jesuits). It will address the details about those Chinese who returned to the city of Beijing to make weapons based on the models of the Manila foundry (artillery pieces called "Lu Song Pao") for the Wanli emperor in 1615 and defend the northern border of the Ming from the invasions of the Jurchen nomads. Later, how this experience about making cannons in Manila by Filipino, Iberian and Chinese hands crossed the American continent to defend the Hispanic Atlantic and Caribbean connection in the important port of Veracruz in New Spain (Mexico). Making an unexpected global circulation of military technology.

Hasegawa Masato - The Ming Withdrawal from Korea and the Beginning of the Imjin War's Aftermath

This presentation examines the ways in which the Imjin War (1592–1598) came to an end from the point of view of Ming and Chosŏn officials at the end of the sixteenth century. Intertwined with the question of when the Imjin War ended was the issue of whether and when the Ming troops should withdraw from the Korean peninsula, which was much debated between Ming and Chosŏn officials at the time. Focusing on the issue of the withdrawal of the Ming troops from Korea between the two major phases of the Imjin War and following the Japanese withdrawal from Korea at the end of 1598, this study probes the manner in which Ming and Chosŏn officials assessed the levels of the military threat that the Japanese posed and the need for the Ming troops to remain in Korea. The continued stationing of the Ming troops required that their logistical needs be met, and the financial and administrative burden fell heavily on the Chosŏn bureaucracy and Chosŏn society at large. Both historical sources and previous studies of the Imjin War have tended to depict the end of the Imjin War as a specific point in time associated with the death of Toyotomi Hideyoshi in the fall of 1598 and the subsequent withdrawal of the Japanese troops from Korea. Analysis of the Ming-Chosŏn debate concerning the withdrawal of the Ming troops shows, however, that an end to the war was never in clear sight from a contemporary perspective, even after the Japanese troops had completed their withdrawal. Based on careful examination of Ming and Chosŏn sources, this study explores the intersections between perceptions of the war's end and anticipation and preparations for the war's aftermath. Highlighted in this analysis are the high levels of uncertainty with which Ming and Chosŏn officials sought to determine the direction of the war and a prolonged process

during which they fiercely debated what an end to the Imjin War would have meant to them.

Louis (Xiangyi) Hou - Embracing Practicality: A Study on the Sources of Seonjo's Post-Imjin-War Military Reform

This paper aims to introduce and analyze the impact of military writings from the mid to late Ming dynasty on King Seonjo's post-Imjin-War military reform. By conducting a comparative analysis of the firearm sections in major works, mainly Mao Yuanyi's Wubei Zhi (武備志) and Qi Jiguang's Jixiao Xinshu (績效新書), this paper argues that there are two literary traditions in the late Ming military technology texts: the Leishu (類書, encyclopedia) tradition and the practical manual tradition. The former is often written by military civil officials or literati. Although it is a military technology work, it often only pursues comprehensiveness and neglects the authenticity of description and the feasibility of its contents as actual combat weapons. The latter is often written by frontline military commanders, with concise writing and straightforward language. In King Seonjo's military reform after the Imjin War, the Choson kingdom heavily relied on the latter tradition of Ming military texts and used Qi Jiguang's Jixiao Xinshu as the main source. In the Imjin War, the Choson kingdom witnessed its deficiency in weaponry compared to the other two East Asian states, especially in firearms which both China and Japan had advanced firearms from various sources. Despite Choson Dynasty's strong Neo-Confucianism tradition since its establishment, it began to adopt practical manuals tradition rather than the Leishu-like military writings which were more in line with the Neo-Confucianism tradition. The common understanding of the "silhak" (K. 실학 Ch. 實學) movement is that it began in the latter half of the 17th century, and was based on Choson intellectuals' reflection on Neo-Confucianism after the Imjin War, and later expanded to fields such as agriculture, geography, and military technologies. The content studied in this paper suggests an alternative and earlier starting point for the "silhak" movement.

Alexander Jost

European Ideas on Orogenesis, Mining and Metallurgy in 17th century China

Transfer of European knowledge - theoretical and applied - based on mathematical sciences was a central element of the Jesuit effort to propagate Christian Religion in Early Modern China. One of the disciplines concerned by this was the study of the Earth including the measurement and mapping of its surface but also the understanding of its interior. The latter was of particular interest to the state, because it included the formation and localization of ore deposits and thus access to the riches of the planet. Based on examples from the Chinese Jesuit treatises Kunyu gezhi (1640)

by Adam Schall von Bell (1591-1666) and Kunyu tushuo (1674) by Ferdinand Verbiest (1623-1688) it will be shown, in which way during this transfer processes geological theory of orogenesis was connected with practical knowlege of prospection, mining or smelting and where the Information came from, which Jesuits used in the compilation of their respective works.

Kang Hyeok Hweon - Military Technology as Literacy: The Codification of Technical Knowledge in Korean Military Workshops, 1592–1635

This paper examines how Chosŏn Koreans codified technical knowledge about military manufacture during and after the East Asian War of 1592–1598. During this period, there was an influx of new knowledge in the Korean military workshops due in part to the increased diversity and complexity of military technologies deployed, as well as to the incorporation of foreign practitioners such as Japanese prisoners of war and Chinese defectors into said workshops. In response, Korean artisans and practitioners drew on their rich tradition of “prototyping” (*kyŏnyang*) to translate, vet, and codify the new knowledge. I examine two materialities in particular—wheellock landmine and saltpeter. While other objects, like the matchlock musket, was not subject to codification (their knowledge was better left to the artisans alone to learn through bodily practices), these cases show that other forms of technological knowledge were. In fact, Korean works about these two technologies became studied and shared in abstract forms—and through new epistemic resources both visual (schematic drawing) and textual (*ŏnhae*, combining vernacular Korean and literary Chinese). I argue that rather than “art for appreciation” or “social documents,” these early works aimed at substantive technical communication. And they subsequently transformed military technology as a form of literacy.

Lee Jeong-il

Tactical Changes and Regional Security in the East Asian War: Chosŏn Perspectives

Through the series of grave defeats from the outbreak of the war, Chosŏn field commanders learned how fleetly the Japanese armies, equipped with keen swords and long spears for close combat along with dreadful arquebus rifles, deployed with adroit maneuvers. A growing emphasis was placed on how to avoid a direct confrontation with the Japanese armies. Along this line, today’s presentation explores the way Chosŏn opted for ‘mountain-fortress tactics,’ combined with infantry-centered operations and the use of gunpowder weapons, without risking mounted combat, integral to the traditional tactics of the Chosŏn armies, or all-out battle on level ground. The other focus of my presentation is upon how the tactical adjustments had a bearing on the Chosŏn-Ming military cooperation. The field commanders envisioned

a large-scale joint operation with the Ming Southern Infantry (南兵) as the most effective breakthrough for a full repulsion of the Japanese armies. The two-tiered approach as above will enable us to structurally delve into the military capability of Chosŏn, the multilayered dynamics of Chosŏn-Ming cooperation, and the international relations of East Asia in the sixteenth century and beyond.

John Lee – Reclaiming the Maritime Periphery: Resources, Ecologies, and the Integration of the Coastal Archipelago in Post-Imjin Korea

Over three thousand islands dot the western and southern shores of the Korean Peninsula, forming a coastal archipelago adjacent to major shipping routes and agricultural centers. Throughout the Chosŏn era, the relationship between the central government and the islands was critical to processes of state formation and social and environmental change. This presentation examines how, in the aftermath of the Imjin War, the Chosŏn state implemented new regulations regarding taxation, forestry, and fishing that further integrated coastal and island communities into a legible administrative framework. Accordingly, specific ecologies such as forests and tidal zones would form the key contours of the relationship between Chosŏn officials and coastal communities, especially in the southwest of the Korean Peninsula.

Liu Yang - From Natives to Captives: The Transformed Lives of the Imjin War Piroins.

The Imjin War not only had a significant political and economic impact on the East Asian world, but one of its most immediate consequences was the creation of a large number of *piroin*, or captives, living in foreign lands. In most previous discussions of the Imjin War captives, scholars have analysed the repatriation of captives from a diplomatic perspective, or have focused on the cultural or technological impact of particular groups in Japan (e.g. the Korean captive ceramists). However, there is a lack of systematic analysis of the actual daily experience of the captives as a whole, regardless of vocational or any other specific characteristics. This paper will focus on the captivity records left by the captives themselves during or after the Imjin War, and will examine the process of transition from natives living in their homeland to captives living in a strange land, investigating their residential patterns, physical appearance, and daily life after their arrival in Japan.

Barend Noordam – Normalizing the Navy: Ming Naval Expansion after the Imjin War

The Imjin War was the second wake up call for Ming civil and military officials in less than half a century that tested and questioned the state of the empire's maritime security measures. The first one was the wave of Sino-Japanese “*Wokou*” piracy incursions which threatened China's south-eastern coasts in the 1550s and 1560s. This

first wave led to a wave of naval technological innovations and to a reconsideration of the usefulness of the originally state-managed naval yards and ordnance manufacturing capabilities in meeting the new technological demands the new threat posed. This discussion was reignited during and following the Imjin War, which was reflected in the renewed circulation of older naval manuals and the compilation of newer ones, often by civil and military officials in cooperation. This phenomenon highlights the sense of urgency the topic of maritime security had shared across different classes of official. This paper uses the efflorescence of naval writings during and after the Imjin War to assess how Ming officials intended to reorganize maritime logistics against the backdrop of a new larger maritime threat, one which was kept alive by the Japanese encroachment upon Ryukyu and supplemented by the continuing proliferation of European maritime actors. Second, innovative technological parameters, like new sea tactics and the introduction of new weapons and ships, will be highlighted as factors pushing the debates on managing maritime resources.

Gowoon Seong - A Study on Ming Ceramics Inscribed with “Great Ming” as a Memorial Function after the Imjin War

Beginning in the later half of the seventeenth century, Joseon Koreans used Chinese ceramics dating from the late sixteenth to early seventeenth centuries as a medium to memorialize the fallen Ming empire. Archaeological excavations have shown that the circulation and consumption of Chinese ceramics on the Korean peninsula were intercepted by the invasion of the *wokou* in 1555. For this reason, Chinese ceramics acquired a scarcity value. After the outbreak of the Imjin War (1592-1598), in which fifteen thousand Ming troops came to the aid of Joseon, Ming generals made gifts of Chinese ceramics to the Joseon royal family, officials, and commoners. Many of these ceramics—which were produced by folk kilns—were inscribed with the characters “Great Ming” on their bases. In the aftermath of the Imjin War, these objects became the focus of Joseon scholars’ conception of “indebtedness to state reconstruction” 再造之恩. This paper synthesizes analysis of archaeological evidence, writings of Joseon scholars, and fieldwork to trace the ritual uses of Ming ceramics in Korea after the establishment of the Qing dynasty (1644-1912). Joseon people developed rituals in which they employed Ming ceramics while facing west in order to memorialize certain Ming emperors. This paper is thus a case study of how Ming ceramic as a material culture can come to bear entirely different meanings when deployed in dramatically different contexts such as Joseon. By observing ritual practices of memorial ceremonies for the lost Ming empire, this study seeks to provide insight into the interaction between material culture and the Ming nostalgia of the Joseon scholars from the 17th century.